

The Web of Inclusion

Everyone's gainfully connected in the cosy club called the Indian Premier League



Ravi Shastri and Sunil Gavaskar are paid \$1 million a year by the BCCI, which is the parent body of the IPL, for being on the governing council and giving commentary at all BCCI matches.



Mansur Ali Khan Pataudi is paid Rs 1.5 crore a year by the BCCI to be on the IPL governing council. His son Saif Ali Khan was part of the failed Videocon bid for Teams 9 and 10.



Rajeev Shukla, Congress MP, Chairman of the BCCI Media and Finance Committee and IPL Governing Council member, had offloaded minor equity in a subsidiary of his BAG Films to Kolkata Knight Riders owner **Shah Rukh Khan**.



Entertainment & Sports Direct, which bought the IPL theatrical rights for Rs 330 crore, transferred it to Crown Infotainment. Crown's sister company UFO Moviez (both are owned by the Valuable Group) remained the technology partner. **Kunal Dasgupta**, the former CEO of Sony who quit after BCCI dragged the company to court over contract violations, is Crown's current CEO.

IMG, IPL's organising partner, which has been paid Rs 43 crore, Rs 33 crore and Rs 27 crore over the first three

years, has just signed a joint venture to develop, market and manage sports in India with Reliance, which owns Mumbai Indians.

WSG, which won the IPL broadcast rights in a joint bid with Sony/MSM in 2008, also handles endorsements for two franchise captains, Mumbai Indians' Sachin Tendulkar and Delhi Daredevils' Gautam Gambhir. The BCCI has questioned Modi in its chargesheet on the "facilitation fee" paid by MSM to WSG Mauritius.



The official airlines partner, umpires partner (at \$26.5 million for five years), and after party rights holder (at Rs 12 crore for 2010) are all with one company, Kingfisher, whose owner

Vijay Mallya also owns Royal Challengers Bangalore.

Global Cricket Ventures (GCV) is IPL's official mobile and Internet partner, 50 per cent of which is owned by Gaurav Burman's Elephant Capital. GCV bought the rights from Live Current Media but the original amount was renegotiated from \$49 million over 10 years to \$20.75 million. Burman is Modi's step son-in-law.

Rajasthan Royals is co-owned by Suresh Chellaram, Modi's brother-in-law.

N. Srinivasan, BCCI secretary is also the MD of India Cements which owns Chennai Super Kings.

Road Ahead For Modi

- The IPL Governing Council, a BCCI sub-committee, has a five-year term.
- BCCI members hauled up for disciplinary reasons have to present their case before a disciplinary committee.
- Members can only be expelled by a special general body meeting with a 3/4th majority of the body which consists of 31 votes.
- To oust Modi from the IPL chairmanship, the BCCI will need to have 24 of the 31 members on its side, while all Modi needs is six people to retain his office.
- All adjudication must be completed within six months pending inquiry.

the gravy train that was the governing council has now evaporated. Those in the BCCI corner say Modi would arrive at the infrequent governing council meetings with announcements, saying that deals had been signed and had merely to be ratified. In Modi's corner, it is said that official signatures are on all documents so if financial crimes were being committed, the accessories should also be punished too.

Ironically, the BCCI constitution which was altered to allow its office bearers to have 'commercial interests' is what Modi is counting on to regain his ground. The BCCI's constitution is particularly specific about disciplinary issues in its Clause 32 and contains three steps. First, Clause 32 (ii) states in the event of any complaint received about indiscipline or misconduct, the

BCCI president "shall refer the same to a Commissioner appointed by the Board to make a preliminary inquiry". Given that there is no Commissioner in the same situation, the clause that Modi will count on next is Clause 32 (iv) which says the Working Committee will submit its findings to the Board and a "Special General Meeting specially convened take appropriate decision by majority of 3/4th members present and voting". When translated into BCCI numberspeak, it means all that Modi requires to be restored to the IPL chairmanship is six votes on his side, while the BCCI would need 24 votes in their favour to keep him out of the IPL. Technically he may be ousted from the BCCI vice-presidency as it is based on nomination. But the IPL governing council is a far more independ-